

Article 91: Resolution / Medicare for All

Arlington Annual Town Meeting 2026
Proponent: Greg Dennis, Precinct 1

“An Act establishing Medicare for All in Massachusetts”

HOUSE DOCKET, NO. 1228 FILED ON: 1/14/2025

HOUSE No. 1405

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Lindsay N. Sabadosa and Margaret R. Scarsdale

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing Medicare for All in Massachusetts.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	<i>1/14/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>1/14/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Shirley B. Arriaga</i>	<i>8th Hampden</i>	<i>6/13/2025</i>
<i>Brian M. Ashe</i>	<i>2nd Hampden</i>	<i>6/20/2025</i>
<i>Christine P. Barber</i>	<i>34th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/18/2025</i>
<i>John Barrett, III</i>	<i>1st Berkshire</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Blais</i>	<i>1st Franklin</i>	<i>2/9/2025</i>
<i>Antonio F. D. Cabral</i>	<i>13th Bristol</i>	<i>2/25/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/3/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>2/4/2025</i>
<i>Leigh Davis</i>	<i>3rd Berkshire</i>	<i>5/13/2025</i>
<i>Marjorie C. Decker</i>	<i>25th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/14/2025</i>
<i>Mindy Domb</i>	<i>3rd Hampshire</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Daniel M. Donahue</i>	<i>16th Worcester</i>	<i>4/2/2025</i>
<i>Michelle M. DuBois</i>	<i>10th Plymouth</i>	<i>5/13/2025</i>
<i>Patricia A. Duffy</i>	<i>5th Hampden</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>1/24/2025</i>

SENATE DOCKET, NO. 2341 FILED ON: 1/17/2025

SENATE No. 860

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

James B. Eldridge

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing medicare for all in Massachusetts.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	
<i>Joanne M. Comerford</i>	<i>Hampshire, Franklin and Worcester</i>	<i>1/27/2025</i>
<i>Paul W. Mark</i>	<i>Berkshire, Hampden, Franklin and Hampshire</i>	<i>1/27/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>John F. Keenan</i>	<i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Michael D. Brady</i>	<i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Paul R. Feeney</i>	<i>Bristol and Norfolk</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Sal N. DiDomenico</i>	<i>Middlesex and Suffolk</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Adam Gómez</i>	<i>Hampden</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Jacob R. Oliveira</i>	<i>Hampden, Hampshire and Worcester</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Julian Cyr</i>	<i>Cape and Islands</i>	<i>2/27/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>2/27/2025</i>

State of Health Care in the United States

↑ high cost

Top OECD Countries in Per-Capita Health Spending PPP International Dollars, not inflation-adjusted						
	Country	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
1	 United States	14,885	13,818	12,898	12,375	11,926
2	 Switzerland	9,963	9,301	9,089	8,392	7,621
3	 Norway	9,393	8,909	8,533	7,890	7,221
4	 Germany	9,365	8,503	8,652	8,103	7,364
5	 Netherlands	8,436	7,615	7,517	7,317	6,516
6	 Austria	8,401	7,697	7,700	7,465	6,295
7	 Luxembourg	8,162	7,247	6,854	6,432	5,859
8	 Sweden	7,871	7,364	6,977	6,617	6,069
9	 Ireland	7,813	7,027	6,748	6,221	5,619
10	 Belgium	7,750	7,178	6,906	6,554	6,097

Health at a Glance 2025, OECD, Nov 2025

↓ poor outcomes



Mirror, Mirror 2024, Commonwealth Fund, Sep 2024

State of Health Care in Massachusetts

98% report having health insurance ¹

41% report difficulty affording health care ¹

13% carry medical debt, more than 20% of Black residents ²

33% report skipping or delaying care due to cost ³

11.5% average rate increase approved by Division of Insurance ⁴

\$3.5B in funding to be stripped annually by One Big Beautiful Bill ⁵

300,000 could lose health coverage under One Big Beautiful Bill ⁵

[1] Massachusetts Health Insurance Survey, CHIA, Dec 2025

[2] Burdened by the Bill: Understanding Medical Debt in Massachusetts, CHIA, Nov 2025

[3] Health Care Access Survey, MassINC Polling Group / Commonwealth Beacon, Aug 2025

[4] Merged Market Summary of Approved 2026 Rates, Mass Division of Insurance, July 2025

[5] MassHealth Federal Updates and Impact, Mass.gov, Mar 2026

Health Insurance Costs for Arlington

Insurance (13-0-1)	2024	2025	2026	2027	\$ change	% change
Total insurance costs (health + other - offsets)	22,077,822	23,241,930	26,210,136	28,941,819	2,731,683	10.42%
	1.40%	5.27%	12.77%	10.42%		
<i>For FY 2027 , the Town Manager is hereby authorized to transfer funds within this budget.</i>						
Group Health / Group Insurance Commission *	19,546,768	20,905,086	23,482,301	26,307,027	2,824,726	12.03%
Group Life Insurance	99,823	99,823	99,823	102,500	2,677	2.68%
Workers' Compensation Insurance	580,000	580,000	600,000	580,000	(20,000)	-3.33%
Medicare payroll tax	1,818,716	1,975,489	2,125,033	2,337,536	212,503	10.00%
Flexible Benefit Plan	38,880	52,000	52,000	52,000	0	0.00%
Medicare penalty	15,000	15,000	12,000	10,000	(2,000)	-16.67%
Employee mitigation **	50,000	75,000	150,000	150,000	0	0.00%
Opt-out program	213,996	207,996	189,997	186,000	(3,997)	-2.10%
TOTAL GROUP HEALTH	22,363,183	23,910,394	26,711,154	29,725,063	3,019,906	11.31%

\$2.8M (12%) increase, nearly 1/5th of the override

We are not alone

Health insurance costs are rising sharply, and Mass. towns and schools districts face a budget nightmare

By [James Vaznis](#) Globe Staff, Updated January 5, 2026, 6:00 a.m.

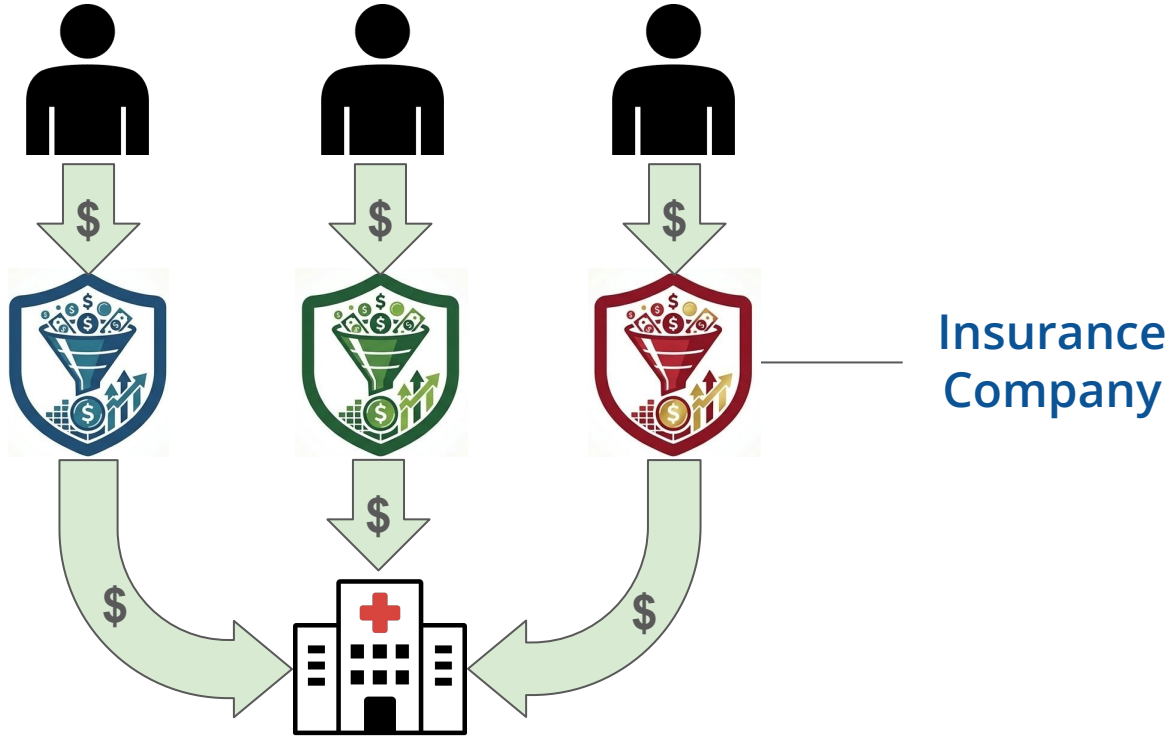
Single-payer healthcare gains momentum in Massachusetts amid affordability crisis

| As health costs climb, more communities are backing proposals for a statewide Medicare for All system

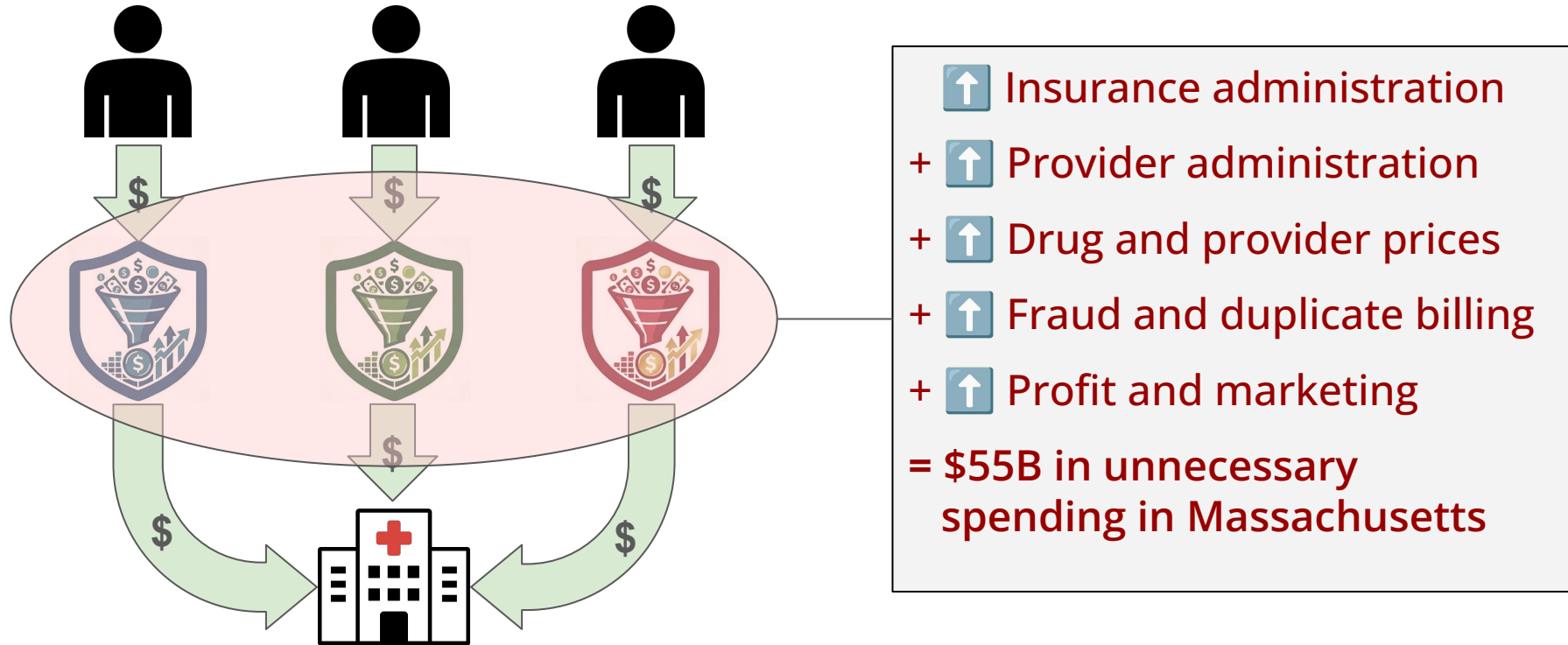
By JAMES NOYES
For the Gazette

May 11, 2026

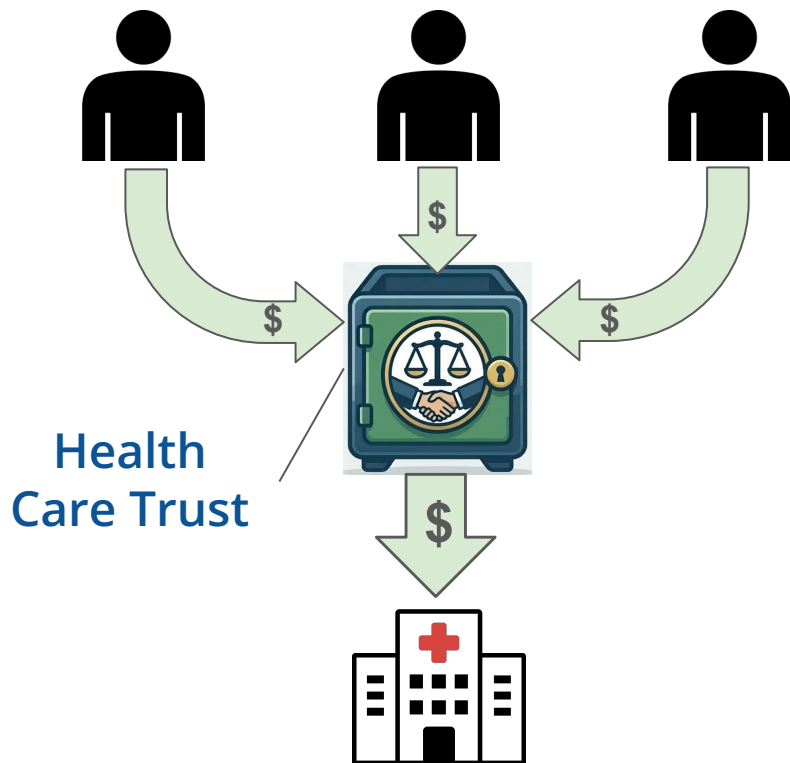
Current Multi-payer System



Current Multi-payer System: Unnecessary Spending



Single-payer system / Medicare for All



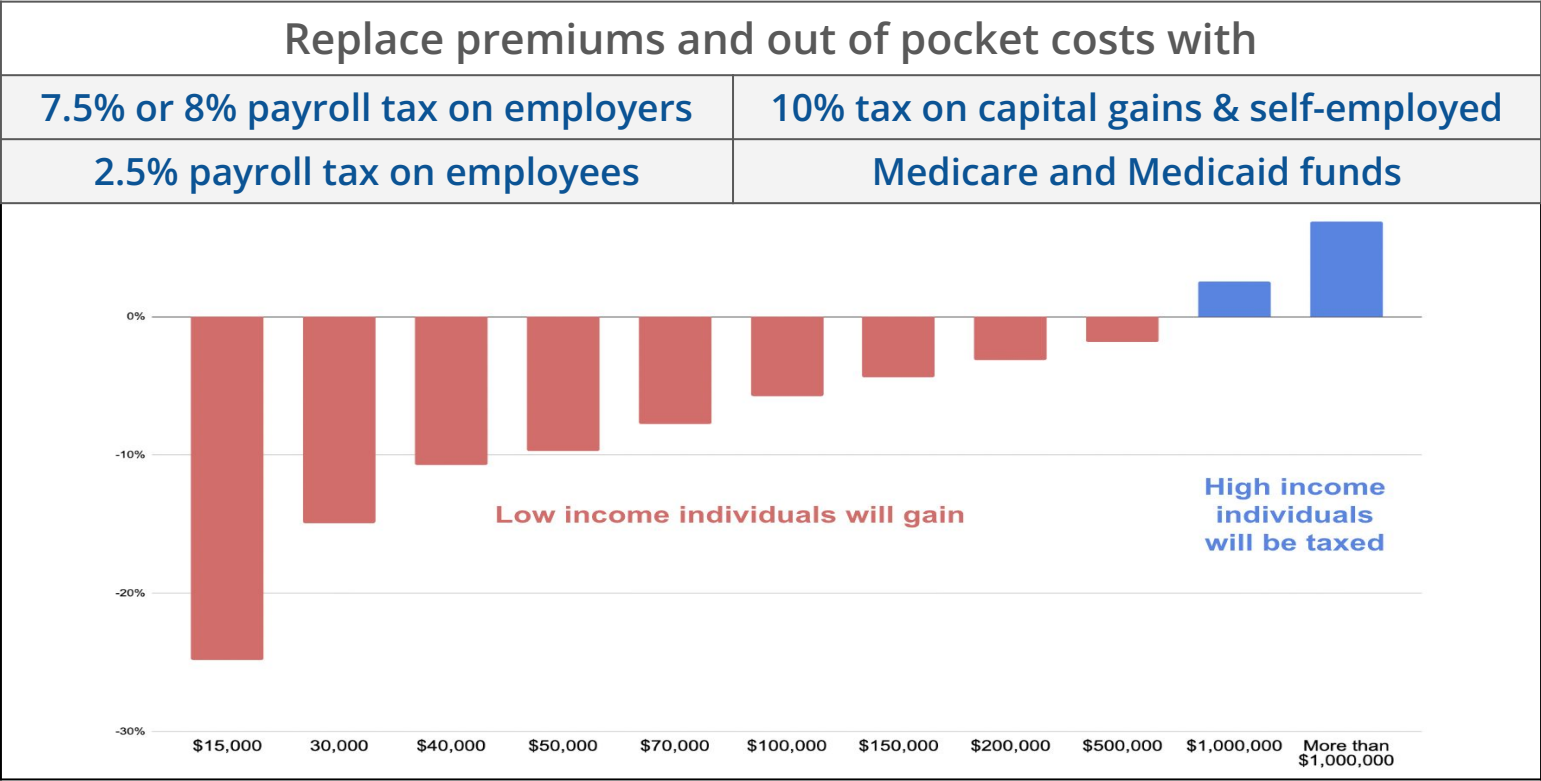
With the \$55B in savings ...

Spend \$25B to fill coverage gaps

- eliminate co-pays
- eliminate deductibles
- eliminate co-insurance
- cover the uninsured
- fill in underinsured gaps

\$30B returned to the economy

Funding Medicare for All



Source: *Funding Universal Health Care in the Commonwealth of Massachusetts*, Jan 2026

What we get

- Comprehensive medical, dental, and long-term care
- No co-pays, co-insurance, or deductibles
- Continue to choose your own provider, as you do today
- Limited role for the private health insurance market
- Universal and equitable: every resident is covered

Arlington Town Savings (FY2027)

Budgeted Health Insurance	\$26,307,027
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Budgeted Salaries (Town+School)	\$127,320,138
Payroll Exemption	- \$20,000
Taxable Payroll	\$127,300,138
Payroll Tax Rate (8%)	x .08
Payroll Tax under Medicare for All	\$10,184,011

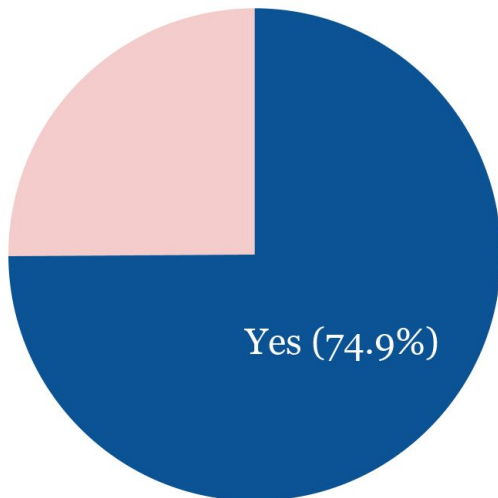
Town Savings under Medicare for All	\$16,123,016
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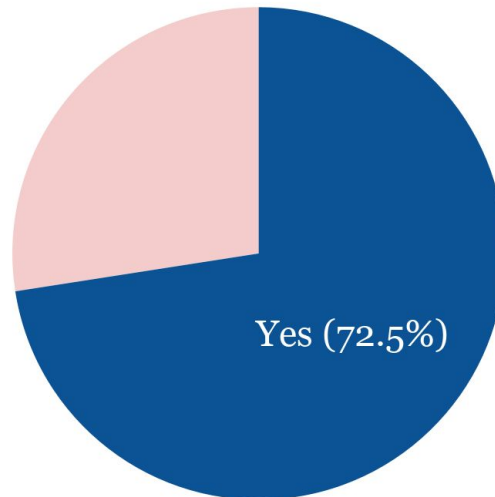
Arlington Voter Support

Shall the representative for this district be instructed to vote for legislation to create a **single payer system of universal health care** that provides all Massachusetts residents with comprehensive health care coverage ... ?

2022 - 23rd Middlesex District - Question 5



2024 - 24th Middlesex District - Question 6



Tell the State: We Need a Real Fix

- Band-aids on a broken private health insurance model are not enough
- Our town and household budgets cannot keep up with costs
- We want a funding mechanism independent of the federal government
- Arlington voters overwhelmingly support a transition to single-payer
- Make Medicare for All a reality in Massachusetts